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Interpersonal Effectiveness Handout 1 – Goals of Interpersonal Effectiveness

- What are the three goals of interpersonal effectiveness?
  - Be skillful in getting what you want and need from others.
  - Build healthy relationships and end destructive ones.
  - Walk the middle path

Interpersonal Effectiveness Handout 2 – Factors in the Way of Interpersonal Effectiveness

- What are some factors that can interfere with our ability to communicate effectively and maintain healthy relationships?
  - Too much interaction with AI chats
  - Strong emotions "hot brain" make things harder to focus on.
    - https://www.hiddenbrain.org/podcast/in-the-heat-of-the-moment/
    - It doesn't have to be challenging emotions like anger or fear, it can be from strong feelings of joy and happiness.
    - Mind-reading and assumptions: this can lead down the wrong path and hinder communication preventing everyone from being communicating with the same understanding.
    - Not listening or not listening partially. Both parties won't have the same information to work from and the party not listening may attempt to fill in the gaps with incorrect information.
    - Other people - outside influences can provide incorrect information without having full and correct context. Other people may have different goals or motives. Watching too many outside resources that provide general or generally incorrect information that may not apply.
    - Short term vs long term goals - not seeing the forest through the trees, we can get caught up in the whirlwind of "now" and let that guide our path, but we may get off the correct path in the "now" and need to be able to find the long term objectives to get back on the right path.
- Identify at least one factor that you have experienced in your own interpersonal interactions.
  - I often take things personally. I think that the other people are blaming me and think that I am not really a great person or at least not very good at what I'm trying to do. This would primarily fit into mind-reading and assumptions.
- Thoughts and beliefs

- My concern for others behaviors could prevent clear or direct communication for concern that it causes problems.
- Due to low self esteem, I may not speak up
- My beliefs about what others "deserve" could prevent me from helping them to improve.

Interpersonal Effectiveness Handout 4 – Clarifying Goals in Interpersonal Situations

- What are the three interpersonal priorities?
  - What is Objectives Effectiveness?
    - Getting what I want or need
  - What is Relationship Effectiveness?
    - Preserving or strengthening a relationship.
  - What is Self-Respect Effectiveness?
    - Maintaining values and respect

Interpersonal Effectiveness Worksheet 3 – Clarifying Priorities in Interpersonal Situations

Locate Worksheet 3 toward the back of your packet.

Think of a recent or current interpersonal situation involving a family member, friend, partner, coworker, or another person.

Complete the worksheet by identifying:

1. The interpersonal situation you would like to address.
   - I am unclear on the "group contract" for interacting in a situation. What is expected from us and how we are supposed to behave.
2. What you hope to accomplish in the situation.
   - I want to understand the group contract - what is acceptable behavior and what should we expect of each other.
3. How important each of the three interpersonal priorities is to you.
   - **Relationship effectiveness** - Clarifying relationship boundaries so that we can understand expectations in the relationship.
   - **Objectives Effectiveness** - This is about my needs so that I can interact with the group at the right level and am able to create and respect boundaries.

- **Self-Respect Effectiveness** - It's important that I can respect others' boundaries so that I am not violating my own values of helping people that spend time in my sphere of influence, or accidentally cross a boundary that I don't know that others have.

4. Which priority is most important in that particular situation.
    - **Relationship Effectiveness** - I want to be clear on how to interact and have safe, healthy, and respectful relationships in a scenario.